This can be a simple chicken broth with just the drizzled egg, but it's more tasty and filling with the addition of vegetables and Chinese seasonings.

chinese egg drop soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 5 MINS **COOK** 25 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1 quart (1 liter) chicken stock
1 garlic clove, crushed
½ tsp grated fresh ginger
2 scallions, chopped
2 tbsp soy sauce
½ tsp Chinese five-spice powder
2 corn on the cob or 1 x 7oz (200g) can sweet corn
2 good handfuls of fresh baby leaf spinach
2 tbsp cornstarch
2 eggs, beaten

1 Put the stock in a pan with the garlic, ginger, scallions, soy sauce, and five-spice powder. If using fresh corn, place each corn on the cob on its end and slide a sharp knife down the length to remove all the kernels. Add the kernels to the pan, bring to a boil, reduce the heat, cover, and simmer gently for 20 minutes.

2 Add the canned sweet corn if using, including any liquid, and the spinach. Bring back to a boil, reduce the heat, and simmer for 1 minute or until the spinach has just wilted. Taste and add more soy sauce if necessary.

3 Blend the cornstarch with 4 tbsp water and stir in. Bring back to a boil and simmer, stirring, for 1 minute to thicken slightly. Gradually trickle in the beaten egg, stirring gently, so that it forms thin strands. Serve in warm soup bowls.